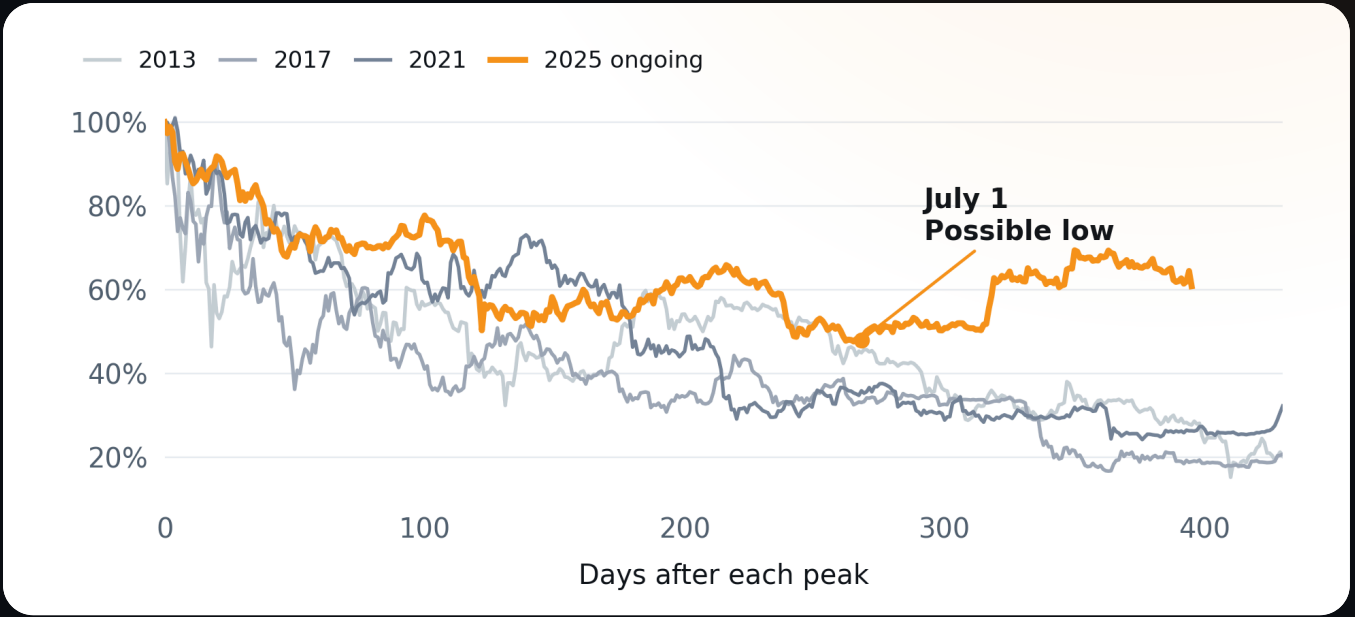
# THE DEAD CYCLE STUDY

What a broken four-year pattern would mean for Bitcoin, and why July remains a possible bottom.

The previous Bitcoin cycles, the conditional 268-day comparison, and all 29 stock-market bear cases behind the carousel.




**268**
Days to July 1, if July holds

**95**
Days shorter than the shortest prior bear

**9 of 29**
Stock cases needing 3+ years to recover

**July is not confirmed as the cycle bottom. The stock-market cases are comparisons, not forecast odds for Bitcoin.**

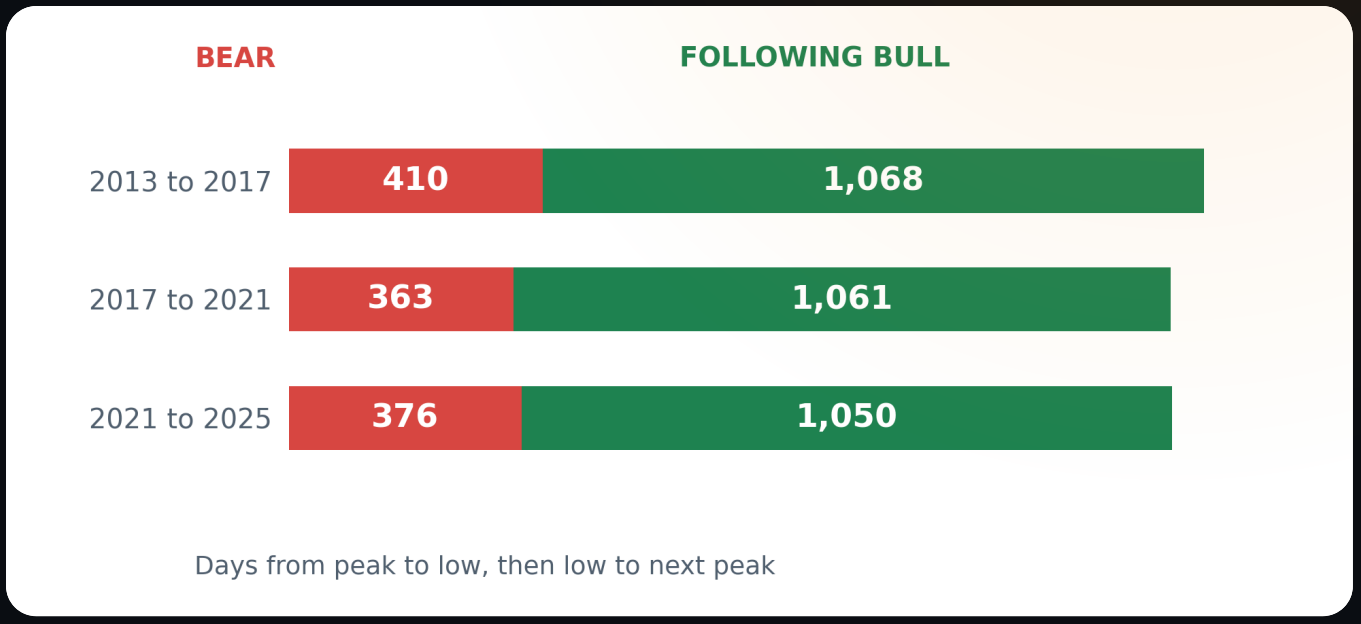


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THREE COMPLETED CYCLES

# ABOUT A YEAR DOWN. THREE YEARS UP.

The previous three completed modern Bitcoin bears lasted **410, 363 and 376 days**. Their following bulls lasted **1,068, 1,061 and 1,050 days**. These are the original study dates, using peak and low prices within each day.




| PEAK | LOW | BEAR DAYS | FOLLOWING BULL DAYS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Nov 30, 2013** | Jan 14, 2015 | 410 | 1,068 |
| **Dec 17, 2017** | Dec 15, 2018 | 363 | 1,061 |
| **Nov 10, 2021** | Nov 21, 2022 | 376 | 1,050 |

That repeated timing is why we have used the cycle to help plan accumulation and profit-taking. Three completed cycles remain a small sample. They do not guarantee the timing of a fourth.

*Bear means peak to the later low. Following bull means that low to the next peak. The study begins with the November 2013 peak; the much earlier 2011 cycle is outside this three-cycle comparison.*

THE CURRENT CYCLE

# JULY IS A POSSIBLE BOTTOM

From **October 6, 2025 to July 1, 2026** is **268 days**. If July holds as the cycle low, the bear would be **95 days shorter** than the shortest of the previous three. It is not a completed-bear observation yet.




| WHAT HAPPENS | WHAT IT MEANS FOR JULY |
|---|---|
| **Price stays above the July low** | July remains a candidate. Holding alone does not confirm it. |
| **Price falls below $57,734.63** | July is ruled out as the cycle low. The carousel rounds this level to $57,735. |
| **The calendar reaches mid-November** | Our current working window ends there. A date cannot confirm the low. |

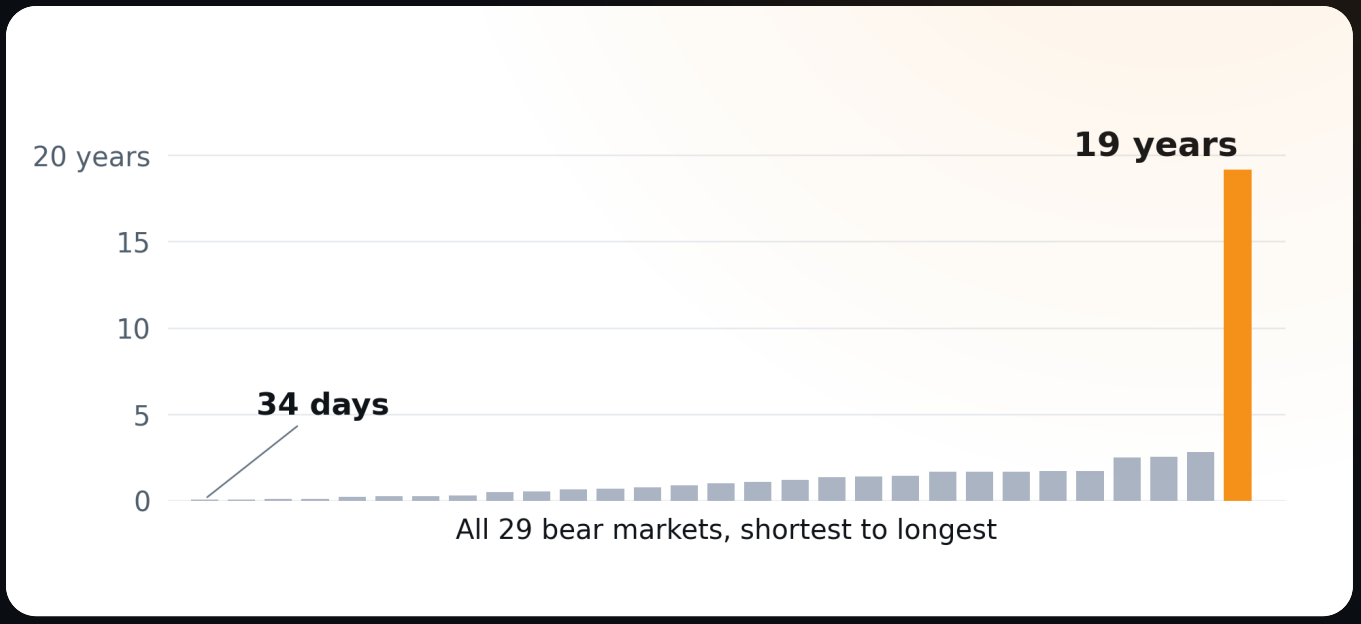
Our working bottom window remains open into **mid-November**. We are not calling the bear finished. If July does hold, an early bottom alone would not establish that the four-year pattern is gone permanently.

*Chart uses actual Bitstamp daily closes through the saved November 5 snapshot. The July marker uses the verified intraday low. The price curve is not a live feed.*

OTHER MARKETS

# THE FALL CAN LAST WEEKS OR YEARS

We counted **29 bear-market episodes** across the S&P historical series, Nasdaq and Nikkei. The shortest decline lasted **34 days**. The longest lasted **7,007 days**, about **19.2 years**, rounded to 19 years on the carousel.




These markets have not followed Bitcoin's familiar one-year bear and three-year bull timing. Their history shows that a market can keep falling after a year has passed. It does not establish that Bitcoin will suffer the same decline.

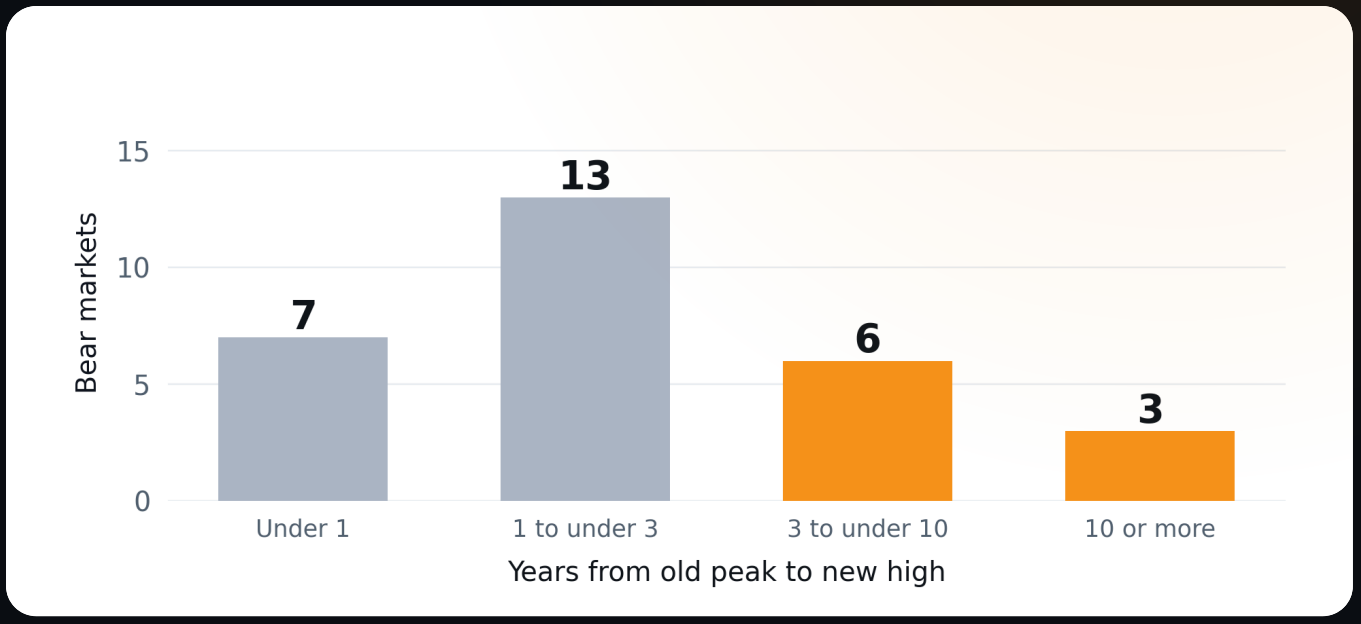
If the four-year pattern stops working, another bear still remains possible. The main change for us is that the previous timing ranges become less useful for planning how long the wait might be.

**This is a comparison of timelines. We have not measured a causal effect of a Bitcoin cycle breaking, or calculated probabilities for the next Bitcoin bear.**

GETTING BACK TO THE OLD HIGH

# THE RECOVERY CAN TAKE MUCH LONGER

The middle result for time from the old peak to a new high was **2.0 years**. **9 of 29 cases** took at least three years. The clock starts at the prior peak, so these waits include both the fall and the recovery.




| MARKET AND PEAK | FALL | PEAK TO NEW HIGH |
|---|---|---|
| **Nasdaq, 2000** | 77% | About 15 years |
| **U.S. stocks, 1929** | 86% | About 25 years |
| **Nikkei, 1989** | 82% | About 34 years |

Finding the bottom ends the decline. It does not mean someone who bought at the previous high has recovered their loss. Those are different dates, and we keep them separate throughout this study.

*Price-only comparisons. Dividends, inflation, currency changes, taxes and trading costs are excluded. The 1929 U.S. series predates the modern 500-stock index.*

EVERY CASE, PART 1

# THE FIRST 15 CASES

| MARKET | PEAK | LOW | FALL | DAYS FALLING | YEARS TO NEW HIGH |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **S&P 500** | Sep 02, 1929 | Jul 04, 1932 | -86% | 1036 | 25.0 |
| **S&P 500** | Jul 30, 1956 | Dec 16, 1957 | -20% | 504 | 2.1 |
| **S&P 500** | Dec 04, 1961 | Jun 18, 1962 | -27% | 195 | 1.7 |
| **S&P 500** | Feb 07, 1966 | Oct 03, 1966 | -22% | 237 | 1.2 |
| **S&P 500** | Nov 25, 1968 | May 18, 1970 | -33% | 538 | 3.3 |
| **S&P 500** | Jan 01, 1973 | Sep 30, 1974 | -48% | 636 | 7.5 |
| **S&P 500** | Nov 24, 1980 | Aug 02, 1982 | -26% | 615 | 1.9 |
| **S&P 500** | Aug 17, 1987 | Nov 30, 1987 | -33% | 105 | 1.9 |
| **S&P 500** | Mar 20, 2000 | Sep 30, 2002 | -48% | 923 | 7.2 |
| **S&P 500** | Oct 08, 2007 | Mar 02, 2009 | -56% | 511 | 5.5 |
| **S&P 500** | Feb 10, 2020 | Mar 16, 2020 | -32% | 34 | 0.5 |
| **S&P 500** | Dec 27, 2021 | Oct 10, 2022 | -25% | 286 | 2.0 |
| **Nasdaq** | Jan 08, 1973 | Sep 30, 1974 | -59% | 629 | 5.7 |
| **Nasdaq** | Feb 04, 1980 | Mar 24, 1980 | -22% | 49 | 0.4 |
| **Nasdaq** | May 25, 1981 | Aug 09, 1982 | -29% | 441 | 1.4 |

*One episode runs from an all-time high through a decline of at least 20%, until a new all-time high. Dates use the original Yahoo weekly-close study snapshot. Recovery years start at the prior peak, not the low.*

EVERY CASE, PART 2

# THE REMAINING 14 CASES

| MARKET | PEAK | LOW | FALL | DAYS FALLING | YEARS TO NEW HIGH |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Nasdaq** | Jun 20, 1983 | Jul 23, 1984 | -30% | 399 | 2.6 |
| **Nasdaq** | Aug 17, 1987 | Nov 30, 1987 | -36% | 105 | 2.0 |
| **Nasdaq** | Oct 02, 1989 | Oct 08, 1990 | -32% | 371 | 1.5 |
| **Nasdaq** | Jul 13, 1998 | Oct 05, 1998 | -26% | 84 | 0.4 |
| **Nasdaq** | Mar 06, 2000 | Sep 30, 2002 | -77% | 937 | 15.1 |
| **Nasdaq** | Aug 27, 2018 | Dec 17, 2018 | -22% | 112 | 0.7 |
| **Nasdaq** | Feb 10, 2020 | Mar 16, 2020 | -29% | 34 | 0.3 |
| **Nasdaq** | Nov 15, 2021 | Oct 10, 2022 | -36% | 328 | 2.3 |
| **Nasdaq** | Feb 10, 2025 | Mar 31, 2025 | -22% | 48 | 0.4 |
| **Nikkei** | Jan 10, 1965 | Jul 18, 1965 | -20% | 189 | 0.8 |
| **Nikkei** | Mar 27, 1966 | Dec 10, 1967 | -21% | 623 | 2.3 |
| **Nikkei** | Apr 05, 1970 | Dec 13, 1970 | -21% | 252 | 1.2 |
| **Nikkei** | Jan 21, 1973 | Oct 06, 1974 | -33% | 623 | 4.7 |
| **Nikkei** | Dec 24, 1989 | Mar 01, 2009 | -82% | 7007 | 34.2 |

*All 29 original observations are retained, including long recoveries. Some indexes fell during the same global selloff. These are not 29 independent global events, and 9 of 29 is not a probability for Bitcoin.*

HOW TO READ THE STUDY

# THE DATES, PRICES AND LIMITS

1. Bitcoin cycle dates use the original study's intraday peaks and lows. Daily-close charts show the path between those dates. Those are different price measurements.
2. Stock bears use weekly closing prices. A case requires a fall of at least 20% from an all-time high before a new high. We count that whole period once.
3. Days falling run from peak to low. Years to a new high run from the same peak to recovery. Recovery time includes the time spent falling.
4. Keep July conditional. A new low below $57,734.63 rules it out. Our mid-November window is our current outlook, not a probability derived from the 29 equity cases.

The original study uses Yahoo weekly data for the S&P historical series, Nasdaq Composite and Nikkei 225. Bitcoin history comes from Bitstamp. This update retains the original 29-case snapshot rather than silently changing the sample.

The pre-1957 U.S. history is a predecessor series. Dividends, inflation, foreign-exchange changes and implementation costs are excluded. Nothing here tests a trading strategy or promises that a cycle can warn of every crash.

**No four-year cycle does not mean no more bear markets. An early July bottom would not settle when the next bear begins or how long recovery takes.**

*Educational research. No guaranteed return, entry signal or confirmed-bottom call. Updated November 5, 2026. Public data sources and more free guides are linked below.*

Bitstamp data · S&P history · Nasdaq history · Nikkei history